WHEN SOMEONE WE LOVE HAS DIED OR IS MISSING

There is no right way to grieve

Grief is a normal response when someone we love has died or is missing. There is no right way to grieve, and no set time when it should end. People grieve in different ways.





1 Looking after yourself

- **Rest when you can.**
  Eat, and drink safe water.
- **Spend time with people you trust.**
  You can talk about the person, or not.
- **Remember the person in your own way, if you wish.**
- **Do one small task at a time.**

2 Children grieve too

- **Answer their questions honestly, in simple words.**
- **Stay close and keep familiar routines.**
- **Let them share memories of the person, if they wish,**
  for example through drawing or stories.

3 If you are helping someone who is grieving

- **Stay close.**
  Listen, or sit quietly.
- **Ask what would help today,**
  for example bringing food, collecting water or helping with a daily task, if they want it.
- ✕ **Avoid saying "be strong", comparing losses, or telling them when they should feel better.**

When to ask for help

If grief makes it very hard to eat, sleep or care for yourself or others for a long time, or you want support at any time, talk to a health worker.

You may notice



Sadness, crying, anger, guilt, or feeling empty



Thinking about the person often, or longing for them



Feeling very tired, or trouble sleeping and eating



Wanting to be with people, or wanting to be alone

When a loved one is missing

You may hope and grieve at the same time. Both are natural. For information, contact _____ (tracing contact, filled in and checked locally). You can ask for support while you wait.

Ask for help early

Grief has no fixed end date. If you want support, or grief is making daily life hard, talk to a health worker. You do not have to wait.

Get help now

In danger, or thinking of harming yourself? Get help now. Ask a health worker or responder, and ask someone you trust to stay with you.

Help near you: _____ (filled in and checked locally)

_____

_____

Look after yourself. Look after each other.

Support is for everyone, including people with disabilities and older people. Ask for large print or more time.

Sources: WHO/UNHCR, mhGAP Humanitarian Intervention Guide (2015); WHO, Psychological First Aid: Guide for Field Workers (2011); IFRC Psychosocial Centre, Supporting grieving family members and friends; IFRC Psychosocial Centre, Working with people experiencing ambiguous loss.

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